ALPHA OMEGA

Modernizing the Army ROTC Recruitment & Onboarding Lifecycle with AI

From applicant form entry to ROTC acceptance & contracting — compressing the ~12-month lifecycle, raising data quality, and reducing risk on a DoD Salesforce + MuleSoft + DocuSign + Azure DevOps stack.

Briefing Deck · Solution Concept · June 2026

Human-in-the-loop by design: AI augments eligibility, selection & clearance work — it never decides.

The challenge: a 12-month, paper-heavy, multi-actor journey

- Re-keying the same identity, education & biographic data across the application, DoDMERB, SF-86 and contracting
- Incomplete or inconsistent submissions that bounce back weeks later and restart clocks
- Manual document collection, verification and status-chasing over email and phone
- Limited applicant visibility into status — driving anxiety, abandonment and inbound inquiries
- Disconnected systems with no single case record; cadre and adjudicators stitch context by hand

~12 mo

applicant form entry → acceptance

4+

major forms & systems, often re-keyed

Weeks

lost per bounce-back / rework cycle

The lifecycle at a glance

Ten connected stages, treated as a single instrumented case

S1 Awareness & Lead Capture

S2 Application Intake

S3 Docs & Eligibility

S4 Fitness & Medical

S5 PMS Interview

S6 Selection Boards

S7 Offer & Acceptance

S8 SF-86 & Adjudication

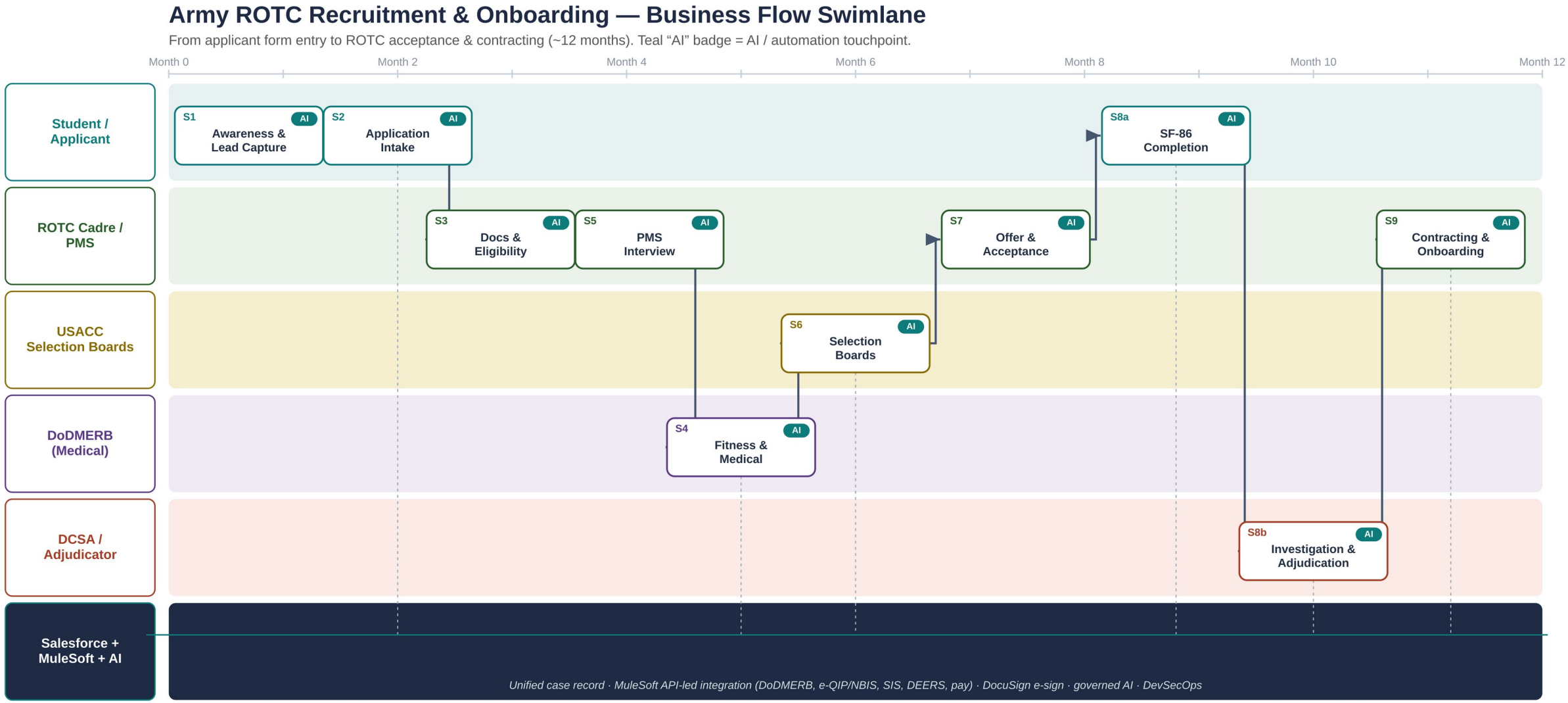
S9 Contracting & Onboarding

S10 Case Mgmt (cross-cutting)

Each stage carries an AI / automation lever — detailed on the following slides.

Business-flow swimlane

Who does what, when — across the ~12-month lifecycle



Designing for two people first

The student completing the forms, and the adjudicator reviewing them

The Student

Today

- Two large, overlapping forms (application, then SF-86)
- Reconstructs 7–10 years of history from memory
- No feedback until a reviewer rejects the packet
- No single view of what's done vs. pending

With AI

- Conversational, guided intake in plain language
- Consented pre-fill reuses data across forms
- Real-time validation & a live 'readiness' score
- Photograph a document → auto-extracted & filed
- Always-on status portal and proactive nudges

The Adjudicator / Cadre

Today

- Manually reads long packets and SF-86s
- Time lost on incomplete submissions & interrogatories
- Tracking across spreadsheets, email, many systems
- Hard to prioritize highest-risk / nearest-deadline

With AI

- Copilot summarizes packet, flags gaps, links evidence to guideline
- Only complete, validated cases reach review
- Queue ranked by deadline & risk; next-best-action
- Unified case record with full, defensible audit trail

Guardrail: AI surfaces and organizes information; eligibility, selection and clearance decisions remain human under SEAD 4.

AI opportunity matrix

Pain → method → platform component → value lever

Stage	Pain today	AI method	Tech component	Value lever
Application intake	Abandonment, partial data	Conversational AI, pre-fill, validation	Salesforce + Azure OpenAI; MuleSoft	Speed + experience
Docs & eligibility	Manual checks, rework	Document AI (OCR/IDP) + rules	Azure AI Doc Intelligence; SF Flow	Quality + risk
Fitness & medical	Scheduling, silent remedials	Scheduling, status sync, prediction	MuleSoft ↔ DoDMERB; ML	Speed
PMS interview	Coordination, scoring drift	Summarization, rubric checks	Azure OpenAI; Salesforce	Quality
Selection boards	Packet assembly, ranking	Auto-assembly, completeness, analytics	Salesforce; Azure ML (human-decided)	Speed + quality
Offer & acceptance	Manual letters, tracking	Generated correspondence, e-sign	DocuSign; SF; Azure OpenAI	Speed
SF-86 clearance	Errors, long cycle	Pre-fill, validation, copilot, triage	SF; MuleSoft ↔ e-QIP/NBIS; Azure AI	All four
Contracting/onboarding	Manual onboarding	Orchestration, provisioning	SF Flow Orch.; MuleSoft; DocuSign	Speed + risk
Case mgmt (cross-cut)	No unified view	SLA automation, next-best-action	Salesforce Service Cloud / PSS	All four

Priority use cases

Sequenced to deliver early value, then intelligence

UC-01

Guided conversational intake

Higher completion, cleaner first-pass data

UC-02

Document AI & eligibility checks

Faster verification, early exceptions

UC-05

Auto packet assembly + scoring

Boards see only complete packets

UC-07

SF-86 pre-fill, validation & copilot

Fewer errors; faster investigation start

UC-08

Adjudicator / reviewer copilot

Major review-time cut; defensible, logged

UC-09

Case prioritization & next-best-action

Right case worked first; fewer breaches

Target-state architecture

API-led, governed AI, secure by design

Experience	Salesforce Experience Cloud portals (applicant & cadre) · conversational assistants · DocuSign signing
Engagement / Case	Salesforce Service Cloud / Public Sector Solutions — system of record, Flow & Orchestration, SLAs, knowledge
AI services	Azure OpenAI & Azure AI (Document Intelligence, ML) + Salesforce Einstein — governed, in-boundary, human-in-the-loop
Integration (backbone)	MuleSoft API-led layer → DoDMERB · e-QIP/NBIS · SIS/enrollment · DEERS/IdAM · pay (capture once, reuse everywhere)
Document & e-sign	DocuSign for offers, acceptance, contracting and consent capture — integrated to the case
Platform & security	Azure at the appropriate DoD Impact Level · zero-trust · RBAC/ABAC · full audit · DevSecOps pipelines

Responsible AI, security & governance

1

Human-in-the-loop by design

AI summarizes, validates and recommends. Eligibility, selection and clearance determinations are made by authorized humans under SEAD 4 — every assisted step logged.

2

Hybrid deterministic + generative AI

Rules engines handle policy-bound checks for predictability and auditability; generative AI handles language tasks within guardrails.

3

Data protection & boundary

PII minimization, encryption, strict RBAC/ABAC, DCSA-aligned SF-86 handling; AI runs inside the accredited DoD boundary at the correct Impact Level.

4

Transparency & traceability

Model evaluation, explainable scoring, and a clear record of how each recommendation was produced — inspection-ready.

Delivery: SAFe + DevSecOps on Azure DevOps

1 SAFe Agile Release Train

Lifecycle-aligned features, PI planning, continuous demos to USACC, DoDMERB & clearance stakeholders

2 Azure DevOps hub

Backlog, boards, repos & pipelines as one delivery system — traceable requirement → deployed change

3 DevSecOps pipelines

CI/CD for Salesforce (SFDX) & MuleSoft with automated test, security scanning, policy-as-code gates, rollback

4 Continuous ATO posture

Security controls & evidence automated into the pipeline to shorten and sustain authorization

Phased roadmap

Crawl, walk, run — value at every step

Phase 1 — Crawl

Foundation

- Unified Salesforce case model & lifecycle
- DocuSign offers/acceptance
- MuleSoft system APIs (DoDMERB, clearance)
- Quick wins: guided intake, document AI, status nudges

Phase 2 — Walk

Intelligence

- SF-86 pre-fill & validation
- Adjudicator copilot
- Automated packet assembly
- Generated correspondence; case prioritization

Phase 3 — Run

Optimization

- Predictive analytics across the pipeline
- Onboarding orchestration
- Continuous data-quality
- Continuous-ATO maturity; expand to other pipelines

Expected outcomes

↓ Cycle time

form entry → acceptance

↑ Data quality

first-pass completeness

↓ Rework

interrogatories / bounce-backs

↓ Burden

cadre & adjudicator hours

Better experience for the student and the adjudicator — with every eligibility, selection and clearance decision firmly in human hands.

Next step: a discovery session and a Continuum Design proof-of-concept to baseline current state and prioritize the first increment.

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